NORTH WALES CIRCUIT

CARNARVONSHIRE

COUNTY GAOL AT CARNARVON

Gaoler. Thomas Prichard.
Salary: none.
Fees: Debtors, £0 3*s.* 6*d.* entrance.
£0 2*s.* 6*d.* discharge.
Felons, £0 13*s.* 4*d.*
Transports: the expense.
Licence: Beer.

Prisoners.
Allowance: Debtors, none.
Felons, 2*s.* 4*d.* a week each. (*See* remarks.)
Garnish: a shilling.
Number:

	Debtors	Felons, etc.		Debtors	Felons, etc.
1774. 27 June	2	1	1782. 21 June	7	0
1779. 24 July	5	1	1782. 24 Sept.	3	0

Chaplain. None.

Surgeon. None.

This gaol, which is also the bridewell, was formerly a chapel, and is in a ruinous condition. Two rooms for debtors, and two for felons: one of the latter down eleven steps, with an aperture eighteen inches by three; the other under the stairs only nine feet by seven, with no window: all of them very dirty, and never whitewashed. Joining to the gaol is a large room, formerly a house of correction, but lately used by strolling players. A court, but no sewer: no water. Neither clauses against spirituous liquors, nor the Act for preserving the health of prisoners, are hung up. Great session in Lent at Conway. The gaoler has £5 a year as keeper of bridewell. He stops from each felon's allowance sixpence a week for (what he calls) his trouble of weekly payments. No table of fees.

Among the various improvements that are making in this town, may it not be hoped, that the county magistrates will think of a better prison.

SOUTH WALES CIRCUIT

GLAMORGANSHIRE

SWANSEY TOWN GAOL

"The debtors' room is very close, and has only one window, which is partly stopped by a shed built against the wall. The room for felons (called the Black Hole) has an aperture in the door, but no window: yet at the Michaelmas quarter sessions, prisoners of both sexes are here confined for some days. In 1787 there were two men and two women confined in it from Monday till Friday. Similar to this is the prison at Neath where one of the quarter sessions is held.[1]

"In my various journeys in England and Wales, I have seen many houses defaced on account of the odious tax on windows; and I cannot help repeating my concern for its pernicious effects. I am persuaded it has a very bad influence on the health of the lower classes of people; and this may be one reason of their not having now such healthy, ruddy complexions as they had formerly. The farmers' servants having been crowded into unventilated rooms or holes, and our labouring poor having been habituated to close habitations, they dislike, when they come into workhouses or hospitals, the admission of fresh air."

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, p. 215.]

[1] "Before I quit this subject, I would just mention, that in all my visits to the gaols and prisons, in this, and other kingdoms, I never received any insults either from keepers or prisoners; nor have I lost anything in any of them, except that in one of our prisons I once lost a large new handkerchief out of my pocket, which I did not miss for some time, but on a subsequent visit, about ten months after, it was immediately presented to me by a prisoner; as, he said, he believed I had dropped it when I was there last."